

Post-incident review PIR-2025-026

Mobile Backend: delayed processing

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 17 November 2025, Mobile Backend experienced delayed processing in production (AU Southeast) for about 12 minutes. The error-rate alert paged the on-call engineer. Investigation found that a feature flag was switched on for every tenant instead of the pilot group.

Impact

Users of Mobile Backend saw delayed processing for about 12 minutes. The service owner, Mobile Engineering, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:12 First signal received.
- 09:22 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:46 Likely cause identified.
- 10:09 Mitigation applied.
- 10:33 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that a feature flag was switched on for every tenant instead of the pilot group.

No dependency outages were reported by upstream providers during the window.

It took time to work out which team owned the affected component.

There was no documented procedure for this failure mode, so responders worked it out live.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Add a pre-deployment check that validates the setting against the production baseline.
- Review alert thresholds so the alert only fires when action is needed.
- Add a synthetic probe that exercises the affected path every minute.